



GYAN



*how the model actually did,
once the games were played*

THE GROUP-STAGE GRADE

33 / 48

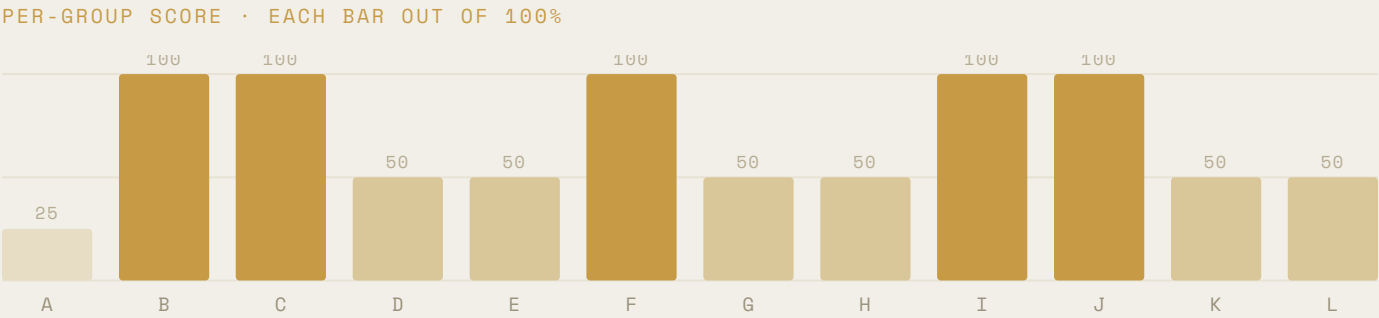
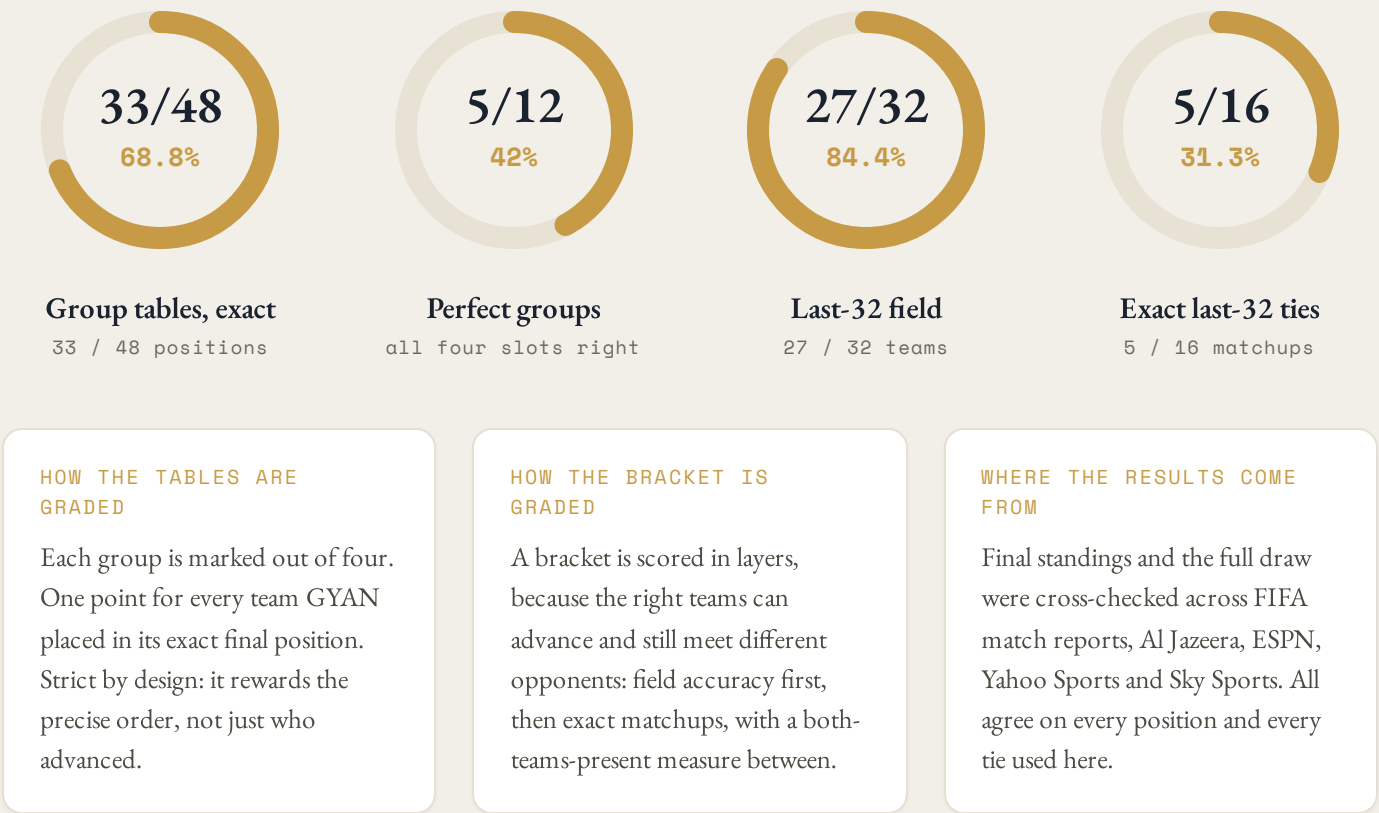
exact group table positions called right across all twelve groups,
a **68.8%** read

and **27 of 32** Round-of-32 teams named before a knockout ball was kicked

A checkpoint review of the four-expert ensemble against the completed group stage and the Round of 32 draw. Predictions as published in *The Bracket*. Educational and entertainment use only.

The scoreboard

Four numbers that sum up how GYAN's published forecast held up once all 72 group games were played and the Round of 32 bracket locked in.



Group by group, A to F

GYAN's projected order against the final standings. One point for each team in its exact finishing place. Green is a hit.

Group A 1 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 Mexico	Mexico ✓
2 S. Korea	S. Africa —
3 Czechia	S. Korea —
4 S. Africa	Czechia —

Group B 4 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 Switzerland	Switzerland ✓
2 Canada	Canada ✓
3 Bosnia	Bosnia ✓
4 Qatar	Qatar ✓

Group C 4 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 Brazil	Brazil ✓
2 Morocco	Morocco ✓
3 Scotland	Scotland ✓
4 Haiti	Haiti ✓

Group D 2 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 USA	USA ✓
2 Turkey	Australia —
3 Paraguay	Paraguay ✓
4 Australia	Turkey —

Group E 2 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 Germany	Germany ✓
2 Ecuador	Ivory Coast —
3 Ivory Coast	Ecuador —
4 Curacao	Curacao ✓

Group F 4 / 4	
GYAN PICK	ACTUAL
1 Netherlands	Netherlands ✓
2 Japan	Japan ✓
3 Sweden	Sweden ✓
4 Tunisia	Tunisia ✓

Group by group, G to L

The back half of the draw. Five groups came out exactly as GYAN ordered them: B, C, F, I and J.

Group G

2 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 Belgium

2

 Iran

3

 Egypt

4

 N. Zealand

1

 Belgium

2

 Egypt

3

 Iran

4

 N. Zealand

✓

—

—

✓

Group H

2 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 Spain

2

 Uruguay

3

 Cape Verde

4

 Saudi Arabia

1

 Spain

2

 Cape Verde

3

 Uruguay

4

 Saudi Arabia

✓

—

—

✓

Group I

4 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 France

2

 Norway

3

 Senegal

4

 Iraq

1

 France

2

 Norway

3

 Senegal

4

 Iraq

✓

✓

✓

✓

Group J

4 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 Argentina

2

 Austria

3

 Algeria

4

 Jordan

1

 Argentina

2

 Austria

3

 Algeria

4

 Jordan

✓

✓

✓

✓

Group K

2 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 Portugal

2

 Colombia

3

 DR Congo

4

 Uzbekistan

1

 Colombia

2

 Portugal

3

 DR Congo

4

 Uzbekistan

—

—

✓

✓

Group L

2 / 4

GYAN PICK

ACTUAL

1

 England

2

 Croatia

3

 Panama

4

 Ghana

1

 England

2

 Croatia

3

 Ghana

4

 Panama

✓

✓

—

—

33/48

Group stage total, 68.8%. Five perfect groups: B, C, F, I and J. Six groups landed exactly two of four, and only Group A slipped to a single hit.

Right cast, fine margins

The group stage played to GYAN's strengths and exposed its one soft spot in the same breath. The model was strong at naming who would be there at the end and weaker at the exact order they finished in.

Most of the misses were not wrong teams. They were single swaps between neighbors. Ivory Coast and Ecuador traded second and third in Group E. Egypt and Iran did the same in Group G. Cape Verde and Uruguay flipped in Group H. Colombia edged Portugal for top spot in Group K. Ghana and Panama swapped the bottom two in Group L. In each case the cast of the group was right and only the fine ordering moved.

Group A was the one real scramble. GYAN had South Korea and Czechia going through, with South Africa last. Instead South Africa surged to second and the knockouts, South Korea fell to third and out, and Czechia finished bottom. Only Mexico at the top was correct, the single weakest group of the twelve.

A handful of advancement calls were beaten outright. Turkey, tipped to finish second in Group D, finished last and went home. Uruguay, GYAN's runner-up in Group H, finished third and out. Iran, pencilled in to advance from Group G, came third and out as well. In their place came South Africa, Australia, Sweden, Cape Verde and Ghana, sides the model had rated a notch lower.

Set against that, the five perfect groups are the headline. Group I and Group J came out clean from first to fourth. The pattern is a model that reads the field well and the seeding less well, which is exactly the seam the Round of 32 review pulls on next.

BY THE NUMBERS

Exact table positions **33 / 48**

As a percentage **68.8%**

Perfect groups **5 / 12**

Both qualifiers right **7 / 12**

Top-two slots right **19 / 24**

Weakest group **A · 1 / 4**

PERFECT GROUPS

B 

C 

F 

I 

J 

The Round of 32, graded

The right teams can advance and still draw different opponents. So the bracket is scored in layers, not pass or fail.

27/32

FIELD

teams in the last 32

11/16

BOTH IN

both teams of the tie

5/16

EXACT

matchup as drawn

16/16

AT LEAST ONE

a GYAN team present

S. Africa

Canada

GYAN drew: South Korea v Canada

PARTIAL

Belgium

Senegal

GYAN drew: Belgium v Czechia

BOTH IN

Brazil

Japan

EXACT

USA

Bosnia

EXACT

Germany

Paraguay

EXACT

Spain

Austria

GYAN drew: Spain v Algeria

BOTH IN

Netherlands

Morocco

EXACT

Portugal

Croatia

GYAN drew: Portugal v Senegal

BOTH IN

Ivory Coast

Norway

GYAN drew: Ecuador v Norway

BOTH IN

Switzerland

Algeria

GYAN drew: Switzerland v Austria

BOTH IN

France

Sweden

GYAN drew: France v Egypt

PARTIAL

Australia

Egypt

GYAN drew: Turkey v Iran

PARTIAL

Mexico

Ecuador

GYAN drew: Mexico v Ivory Coast

BOTH IN

Argentina

Cape Verde

GYAN drew: Argentina v Uruguay

PARTIAL

England

DR Congo

EXACT

Colombia

Ghana

GYAN drew: Colombia v Croatia

PARTIAL

WHY THE FIELD BEATS THE BRACKET

The published bracket is the single most likely path, where the favorites win their groups cleanly. The opponent a team draws then hangs on its exact finishing place and the third-place table, so one small upset reshuffles the pairings. South Africa taking second in A, Ivory Coast second in E, and Colombia first in K each scrambled a corner of the draw while the right teams still advanced. That is expected behavior for one deterministic path drawn from a 100,000-run simulation. The distribution is the product; the printed bracket is a snapshot.

The Black Stars cleared the grass

GYAN's single most likely bracket sold the Black Stars short by exactly one place, and the model said as much in advance. The printed path had Ghana fourth and out. The simulation underneath kept insisting they had a real pulse, and page seven in the original published paper highlighted that hedge clearly.

Ghana repaid the hedge. They beat Panama, held England to a goalless draw that proved decisive, and lost only narrowly to a Croatia side that needed a real fight to leapfrog them. The point against England is the one that carried them into the best-third places.

The two firm structural calls landed. England won the group and Croatia took second, the rematch of their 2018 semi-final exactly as forecast. Only Ghana's own finish moved, from the predicted fourth to a third that was good enough for the knockouts under the new, third-friendly format, which is the precise door the spotlight had pointed at.

So the single printed bracket got Ghana wrong, and the simulation behind it got them right. Ghana now meet Colombia in Kansas City, underdogs again, ranked below their opponent again, and once more heading to the exact spot where this team has made a continent hold its breath before.

GHANA · HOW IT LANDED

Model finish	4th
Actual finish	3rd
Outcome	Through
Route	Best third

GROUP L · FINAL

 England	7
 Croatia	6
 Ghana	4
 Panama	0

THE RUN

 1-0  · 
 0-0  · 
 1-2  · 

NEXT · ROUND OF 32

 Colombia v  Ghana
Jul 3 · Kansas City

What the group stage taught us

- 01** **The model reads the field well.** Thirty-three of forty-eight on strict table positions, five perfect groups, and twenty-seven of thirty-two last-32 teams named in advance. GYAN was rarely wrong about who would matter.
- 02** **Its soft spot is fine seeding.** The 84.4% field accuracy against 31.3% exact matchups is the clearest signal: small in-group upsets cascade into a different bracket even when the right teams go through. That is the story here.
- 03** **The honest hedging paid off.** Ghana finished one place above the printed call, through the very route the Black Stars spotlight flagged. Publishing the distribution and its caveats, not just the single path, earned its keep.

METHOD

Four-expert ensemble · 100,000
Monte Carlo simulations

NEXT

Round-by-round tracking through the
knockouts

BUILT BY

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github.com/rofyray/gyan